

Course Map for Fundamentals of Music Production

Course Outcomes

After completing this course, students will be able to:

Code	Course Outcome
C1	Use music production software to realize musical ideas
C2	Utilize the landscape of third-party Virtual Instruments and Plugins
C3	Enhance projects using audio effects and automation techniques
C4	Mix and master music projects

Module 1: Basics of Ableton Live

Topics Covered

- Ableton Live installation and basic audio output
- Audio/Midi Tracks and Audio/Midi Clips
- Using midi tracks, outputting audio with basic sounds, presets, and the piano roll
- Splitting, combining, trimming, and fading audio clips

After Module 1, students will be able to:

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment
Download and configure Ableton Live	Export first mini-project as .mp3 or .wav and submission. (Personal Project 1)	• Ableton Live 10 or 11 • Computer • May need to review Ableton Live docs for help	C1, C2
Add audio and midi tracks in arrangement view, edit audio files with splitting, combining, and trimming	Personal Project 1	• Ableton Live 10 or 11 • Computer	C1
Create loops using basic Ableton sounds and midi tracks	Personal Project 1 Discussion Board Reflection on Module 1 Topics	• Ableton Live 10 or 11 • Computer	C2

Module 2: Sounds, Recording, VSTs, and Plugins

Topics Covered

- Basic Synths and Presets Ableton Live provides
- Exploring ADSR with Ableton's Drift synth
- VSTs and Plugins
- Supplemental: Recording in Ableton

After Module 2, students will be able to:

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment
Explore Ableton Live presets and utilize Attack, Decay, Sustain, Release	Personal Project 2 using sounds with different ADSR	• Ableton Live • Computer	C2
Locate and compile a list of free VSTs/Plugin resources	Resource List Compilation Live Doc	• Ableton Live • MS365 Word	C2
Add, edit, and configure VSTs and Plugins	Personal Project 2 incorporating at least 1 VST or Plugin	• Ableton Live • Computer • Free VST or Plugin of your choice	C1, C2
Supplemental/Optional: Record Live Instruments in Ableton	Personal Project 2 Discussion Board Reflection on Module 2 Topics	• Ableton Live • Computer • Microphone • Any Instrument or your voice	C1, C2

Module 3: Audio Effects and Automation

Topics Covered

- Basic effects in Ableton
- Equalization: The frequency spectrum
- Compression: When and how to use it
- Automation and filtering

After Module 3, students will be able to:

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment
Define and understand basic effects in Ableton, such as Reverb and Delay	Personal Project 3 incorporating both reverb and delay effects	Ableton Live Computer	C3
Use advanced effects (Equalization and Compression) to enhance their music	Frequency Spectrum Analysis	- Ableton Live - Computer	C3
Utilize automation and filtering techniques to evolve and change effects and sounds over time	Personal Project 3 incorporating automated effects and filtered sounds Discussion Board Reflection on Module 3 Topics	- Ableton Live - Computer	C3, C4

Module 4: Mixing and Mastering

Topics Covered

- EQ Techniques
- Basic effect chains in Ableton for mastering
- Volume Control and reference material

After Module 4, students will be able to:

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment
Use EQ to boost and cut wanted and unwanted frequencies	Personal Project 4 utilizing EQ8 in Ableton Live	- Ableton Live - Computer	C4
Explore and utilize Ableton Effect Chain presets	Personal Project 4 utilizing at least 1 effect chain	- Ableton Live - Computer	C3, C4
Balance channel volumes to achieve desired volume in their project export	Personal Project 4 revisit with adjusted channel volumes Discussion Board Reflection on Module 4 Topics	- Ableton Live - Computer	C4

Module 5: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Module 6: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Module 7: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Module 8: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Module 9: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Module 10: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Module 11: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Module 12: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Module 13: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Module 14: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment

Module 15: [Topic]

Module Learning Outcomes	Assessments	Materials	Course Outcome Alignment